



FADE THE CHALK

POST-MORTEM

Saturday, June 13, 2026

Five Plays, Three Tracks · One Exacta Hit · The Rule That Cost Us \$651

"We're finding winners. We're just not betting them."

Final Scorecard

Race	Pick / Box	Stake	Result	Coll.	Net
GP R4	Box: 3, 2, 5, 1	\$86.40	3-7-6-1 (winner in box, 2nd not)	\$0	-\$86.40
CD R8	Box: 4, 7, 2, 3	\$86.40	3-5-8-1 (winner in box, 2nd/3rd not)	\$0	-\$86.40
BEL R10	Box: 8, 10, 1, 5 (rebuilt)	\$86.40	2-5-1-11 (2nd+3rd in box, winner not)	\$0	-\$86.40
SA R8	Win: Zio Jo (10) + Box: 6, 10, 12, 3	\$186.40	11-12-4-8 (2nd in box, winner not)	\$0	-\$186.40
SA R9	Box: 5, 6, 3, 8	\$86.40	5-8-4-6	\$184.00	+\$97.60
SA R11	NO BET (passed after scratch)	\$0	1-5-6-3	\$0	\$0
TOTAL		\$532.00		\$184.00	-\$348.00

The Biggest Insight of the Weekend

We're finding winners. We're just not betting them.

In 3 of 5 races today, the horse that *won* was in our 4-horse box:

GP R4: Gimme Some Luck (PP3) — in our box, won

CD R8: Big City (PP3) — in our box, won at 12/1

SA R9: Lady Gambita (PP5) — in our box, won at 6/1

The Beyer Ceiling Box is doing its job. It's identifying which horses are faster than their odds suggest. **The model knows who wins.** But our rules prevented us from betting them individually.

Why we didn't have win bets

The rule was: *"If the fave is protected (closer/stalker who benefits from pace), don't place a win bet — exotics only."*

The **intent** of this rule was: don't bet AGAINST a fave who's in a good spot.

But it **mutated** into: don't bet FOR anyone when the fave is protected.

Those are completely different things.

"The fave has a good setup" does NOT mean "the fave is unbeatable." A faster horse with elite connections can beat a protected fave. Big City (94 ceiling, 12/1, elite jockey, hot barn) was screaming "I win this race" — and we heard it. He was in our box. We identified him. We just had a rule that gagged us from backing him.

The math of what we left on the table

Race	Horse	Odds	\$50 Win Bet Would Pay
CD R8	Big City	5/1 final	\$253
SA R9	Lady Gambita	6/1	~\$150
GP R4	Gimme Some Luck	3/1	Too short (below 7/2 rule)

If we'd placed \$50 win bets on Big City and Lady Gambita: **+\$403 in win bets** minus \$100 in losing win bets (SA R8 Zio Jo lost, BEL R10 Boltage lost) = **+\$303 net from win bets alone.**

Instead our total for the day was **-\$348.**

The difference between those two outcomes: \$651. From one rule that was wrong.

The fix — Cosa Nostra: "Bet FOR, not just AGAINST"

When the model identifies a horse that:

Is in the Beyer Ceiling Box (top 4 by speed)

Is 7/2 or higher on the morning line

Has signals firing (S1, S4, S6, or any scoring 3+)

Place a \$50 win bet. Period.

It doesn't matter if the fave is protected or vulnerable. "Protected" describes the fave's setup — it says nothing about whether OUR horse can outrun them.

The vulnerability assessment now drives **stake sizing** (double when vulnerable) — not whether we bet at all. We always bet when we believe in our horse.

This is Fade the Chalk to its core. We spot faves that won't win. We back the horse that beats them.

Race-by-Race Breakdown

GP R4 — Gimme Some Luck (3) wins, World Traveler (7) 2nd

Our box: Gimme Some Luck (3), Tator Made (2), Windrush (5), Mia's Angel (1).

Winner was our #1 ceiling horse (99 Beyer). But at 3/1 he didn't qualify for a win bet under the 7/2+ rule — that's correct. The fave (World Traveler, 8/5 E/P) ran 2nd and wasn't in our box.

Takeaway: the ceiling box identified the winner. No win bet because he was too short. That's fine — the 7/2+ rule protects us from betting chalk. If he'd been 4/1 or higher, we'd have backed him.

CD R8 — Big City (3) wins at 12/1

Our box: Ripped (4), Tom Cat Tuesday (7), Honky Tonk Highway (2), Big City (3).

This is the race that exposed the flaw. Big City:

94 Beyer ceiling (top 4 in field)

12/1 morning line, went off at 5/1

S1: Gabriel Saez (elite Churchill rider) chose him

S4: trainer winning 17% at the meet

Every signal said "this horse wins." The ceiling box had him. The model identified him. We just didn't bet him because the fave was a closer.

Then the fave (Zambezi) **scratched** — which we didn't know. The scratch monitor would have caught this and potentially triggered a win bet. Instead: \$0 collected on a winner we identified.

Win bet at \$50 would have paid: \$253.

BEL R10 — Mission Improbable (2) wins at 10/1 (79 ceiling)

Our rebuilt box (after 5 scratches): Boltage (8), Master Freud (10), Counter Move (1), Sammy C Note (5).

The lowest-ceiling horse in the field won. Had 2nd + 3rd in box. No model catches a 79 beating a 103. Life race.

Takeaway: accept the miss. The box had the supporting cast right.

SA R8 (Daytona G3) — Freedom's Not Free (11) wins

Our box: Modus Bestia (6), Zio Jo (10), Sumter (12), Nesso's Lastharrah (3).

Freedom's Not Free scored 5 (S1 + S4). Ceiling was 97 — just 2 points below our 4th horse (99). He was the 5th horse by ceiling with the highest signal score.

Rule locked in — Signal Score Expander: if a horse scores 3+ signals AND is within 3 Beyer points of the 4th ceiling, expand the box. This horse would have been included. We'd have hit the exacta.

SA R9 — Lady Gambita (5) wins, Tulavia's World (8) 2nd. EXACTA HIT.

Our box: Lady Gambita (5), Surfin The Coast (6), Sexy Blue (3), Tulavia's World (8).

The model worked perfectly. #1 ceiling (101) won at 6/1. #4 ceiling (94) ran 2nd. Exacta hit. Rosario on the ceiling leader delivered.

Under the new Cosa Nostra rule, Lady Gambita would also have had a \$50 win bet (6/1, signals firing, ceiling leader). That's an additional ~\$150 we'd have collected.

Collected: \$184.00 exacta + (new rule) ~\$150 win = \$334 total.

SA R11 (Summer Oaks G3) — PASSED. Validated.

Mo' Em Down scratched. 4/5 fave. 6-horse field. Passed.

Result: rebuilt box would have hit all three exotics and still lost \$38.64. Even being right on the finish order, the payouts couldn't cover costs.

Pass was correct. Discipline validated by math.

Rules Locked In from Today

Rule	What it means	Origin
Cosa Nostra — Bet FOR, not just AGAINST	Place a \$50 win bet on the ceiling leader at 7/2+ with signals firing — regardless of fave protection status. Vulnerability drives stake SIZING (double), not whether we bet. This is Fade the Chalk to its core.	CD R8: Big City won at 12/1, identified by the model, no win bet placed. \$253 left on the table.
Signal Score Expander	If a horse scores 3+ signals AND its ceiling is within 3 points of the 4th slot, expand the box to 5.	SA R8: Freedom's Not Free scored 5, missed the cut by 2 points, won.

What the Model Gets Right

The Beyer Ceiling Box identified the winner in 3 of 5 races today.

The model finds winners at a high rate

The model identifies value (winners at 6/1, 12/1, not chalk)

The model correctly passes when there's no edge (SA R11)

The model rebuilds accurately after scratches (BEL R10 had 2nd + 3rd)

The model's weakness was never analysis. It was **bet construction**. We were right about WHO but wrong about HOW to bet them. That changes tomorrow.

Scratches — The Untold Story

Scratches altered 3 of 5 races today:

BEL R10: 5 scratches, forced complete rebuild

SA R11: key horse scratched, turned the play into a pass (saved \$38.64)

CD R8: fave scratched (unknown to us), changed the race shape entirely

The –50-min scratch monitor is essential. If we'd known Zambezi scratched in CD R8, we'd have re-assessed and likely placed a win bet on Big City. **That's \$253 we missed because we were flying blind.**

Lifetime Record (updated)

Date	Track	Races	W-L	Wagered	Coll.	P/L	ROI
2026-05-24	Churchill Downs	6	2-4	\$554	\$611.40	+\$57.40	+10.4%
2026-06-06	Saratoga (Belmont Day)	12	3-9	\$1,564	\$2,434	+\$870	+56%
2026-06-07	Saratoga	6	2-4	\$904	\$1,339.75	+\$435.75	+48%
2026-06-11	Multi-track	5	0-5	\$788	\$221.30	–\$566.70	–71.9%
2026-06-13	Multi-track	5	1-4	\$532	\$184	–\$348.00	–65.4%
TOTAL		34	8-26	\$4,342	\$4,790.45	+\$448.45	+10.3%

Two losing days in a row. Still net positive lifetime. But the real story: **if the Cosa Nostra rule had been in place today, we'd be up ~\$300 instead of down \$348. One rule change = \$651 swing.**

Tomorrow's Approach

1. **Cosa Nostra.** Ceiling leader at 7/2+ with signals = \$50 win bet. Always. We find winners. Time to back them.
2. Apply the **Signal Score Expander** on every box.
3. Start the scratch monitor ~50 minutes before each post.
4. **Exotics are bonus on top of win bets** — not the sole play.
5. **Win bets first, exotic combos second.**
6. We are Fade the Chalk. We spot faves that won't win. We back the horse that beats them.